

Speaking Activity: Workplace Communication

Activity 1: The Office Mystery

Work with a partner. Imagine you just arrived at your office desk in Santiago and found a mysterious, unmarked folder. Read the scenario and take turns asking and answering the questions below using **someone**, **anyone**, **no one**, **something**, **anything**, or **nothing**.

Discussion Prompts:

1. Do you think **someone** left this folder for you on purpose, or did they make a mistake?
2. Is there **anything** inside the folder (like a note or a business card) to identify the owner, or is there **nothing** but blank paper?
3. If you need help figuring out who owns it, is there **anyone** in your department you would ask first?



Activity 2: Workplace Stress & Quantifiers

Think about your current job or studies. Some things cause us stress because there is "too much" of them, while other things are difficult because we have "too little" or "not enough".

Interview your partner about their daily workplace frustrations. Complete the chart below based on their answers, using quantifiers like **many**, **much**, **a few**, **a little**, **too many**, and **too much**.

Countable Frustrations (emails, meetings, phone calls, interruptions)	Uncountable Frustrations (stress, noise, traffic, work, time)
--	--

Partner's Response: 	Partner's Response:
---	---

Follow-up Discussion: Now, offer solutions to your partner's problems. Use indefinite pronouns to suggest ideas (e.g., "Maybe **someone** can help you filter your emails," or "You need to find **somewhere** quiet to work").

Activity 3: Roleplay - The Last-Minute Presentation

Roleplay this quick professional scene with your partner. Take turns being **Employee A** and **Employee B** to practice spontaneous conversation.

Scenario: There are only **a few** minutes left before a major project presentation. You need to make sure everything is ready, but there is **too much** confusion and **not much** time.

Employee A (Manager)

- Ask if **someone** has checked the slides.
- Ask if there is **anything** missing from the meeting room.
- Complain that there is **too much** noise in the hallway.

Employee B (Assistant)

- Explain that **no one** has seen the client yet.
- Say you have **a little** time to fix the projector.
- Confirm that **nothing** is missing from the presentation file.

Answers

Note: Because these are speaking activities, student answers will vary. Below are model patterns for correct grammatical usage during the tasks.

Activity 1 Model Answers:

1. I think **someone** left it by mistake. **No one** usually leaves folders on my desk without telling me.
2. I hope there is **something** inside, but if there is **nothing**, I will ask my supervisor.
3. Yes, I will ask if **anyone** in HR knows about it.

Activity 2 Model Answers:

Countable: I have **too many** meetings every Monday. I only have **a few** minutes to check my inbox.

Uncountable: There is **too much** noise in my shared office space. I don't have **much** time to finish my weekly reports.

Solution: Maybe **someone** can reschedule some of those meetings, or you can find **somewhere** quiet to work.

Activity 3 Model Dialogue:

Employee A: Has **someone** checked the slides? We do not have **much** time!

Employee B: Yes, **everyone** is ready, and **nothing** is missing from the file. But **no one** has seen the client yet.

Employee A: Excellent. There is **too much** noise out there, let's close the door.

Employee B: Good idea. I still have **a little** time to double-check the audio connection.